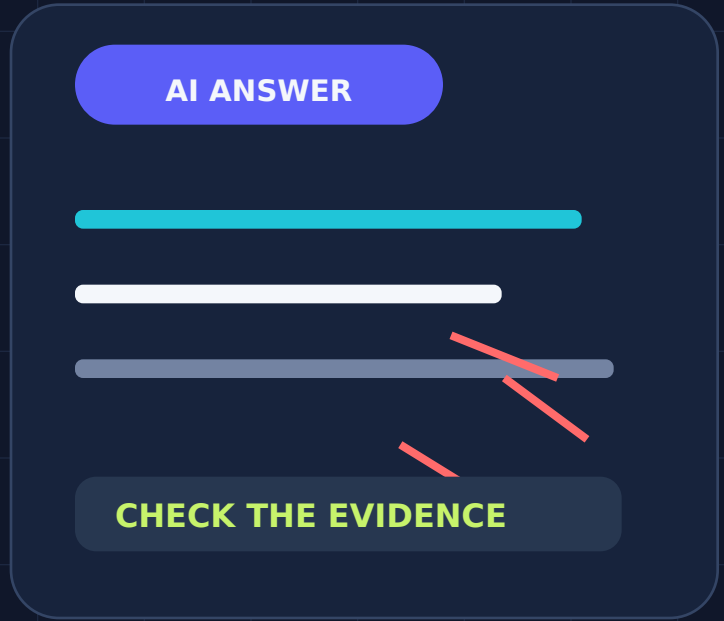
ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE / 5 MIN

AI

HALLUCINATIONS

Why AI can sound certain and still be wrong.

A confident answer is not always a true answer.



A convincing answer can still be wrong.

An AI hallucination is information that is false, made up, or not backed by evidence.

MADE-UP FACTS

Names, dates, numbers, or events that are not true.

FAKE SOURCES

Books, papers, quotes, or links that do not exist.

FALSE CONFIDENCE

Smooth wording that makes a wrong answer sound right.

FLUENT DOES NOT ALWAYS MEAN FACTUAL.

The answer looks real. The source may not exist.

A student asks:

"Can you find a paper that proves this claim?"

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

A made-up paper title

Author: A. Example | Year: 2024

It may look real, but the paper could be fake.

CHECK BEFORE YOU USE IT

1. Search for the paper
2. Check the author
3. Open the original source

A convincing citation is not proof that a source exists.

Why can AI get things wrong?

AI builds answers from learned patterns and the details you give it.

01

MISSING CONTEXT

A vague question can lead to wrong guesses.

02

LIMITED INFORMATION

It may not have the facts needed.

03

ANSWERS ANYWAY

It may answer even when proof is weak.

04

EXACT DETAILS

Dates, figures, and names can be wrong.

Four steps before you trust an AI answer.

Do not stop at the link. Open it and check what it says.

01

ASK CLEARLY

Give useful details.

02

FIND EVIDENCE

Ask for a source.

03

VERIFY IT

Read the source.

04

USE CAREFULLY

Keep what checks out.

ASK → FIND EVIDENCE → VERIFY → USE

A source must support the claim—not just look official.

The bigger the risk, the more you must check.

01 COLLEGE WORK
Check facts, quotes, and sources.

02 HEALTH & LAW
Check with trusted experts.

03 NEWS & EVENTS
Check dates and compare sources.

04 CODE & SOFTWARE
Test it and check the docs.

Never use an unchecked AI answer for a high-risk choice.

Vibe coding is fast. Check the code.

AI can help build an app from your instructions—but it can still make mistakes.

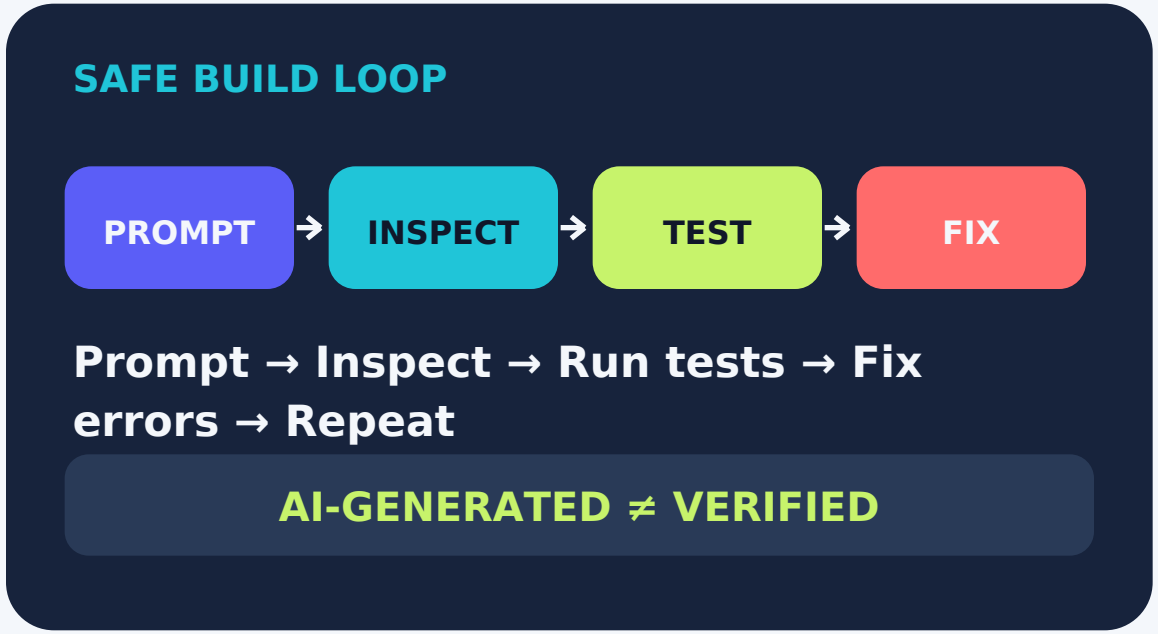
1 BUILD SMALL
One feature at a time.

2 READ THE CODE
Check APIs, files, and settings.

3 TEST EACH CHANGE
Try good, bad, and empty inputs.

4 CHECK THE DOCS
Confirm names and versions.

5 CHECK SECURITY
Protect keys and user data.



AI errors can be fake APIs, wrong assumptions, bugs, or security risks.

THE TAKEAWAY

Use AI to help you think. Use evidence to decide what is true.



- **PAUSE** Does this claim need checking?
- **CHECK** Can I prove it with a source or test?
- **THEN USE IT** Trust only what the evidence supports.

Questions?

Your AI check-list.

Keep these five habits every time you use AI.

FACTS	Check names, dates, numbers, and quotes.
SOURCES	Open links and make sure they exist.
CONTEXT	Check that the answer fits your question.
CODE	Test features, edge cases, and security.
DECISIONS	Ask an expert when the risk is high.

PAUSE. VERIFY. TEST. THEN USE.